

LEAD

1. Core pronunciation split

****lead**** has two major pronunciations depending on meaning:

/li:d/

Usually:

* verb ****lead****

* noun meaning leadership / first position

/led/

Usually:

* noun ****lead**** = the metal ****鉛****

This pronunciation split is extremely important.

PART A — LEAD /li:d/

Core verb meanings

2. lead — guide someone to a place

= go in front of someone and show them where to go

****帶領；引領；領路****

Examples

1. She ****led us to the meeting room****.

她****帶我們到會議室****。

2. The guide ****led the group through the forest****.

導遊****帶領整個團體穿過森林****。

3. lead someone somewhere

= cause or guide someone to move toward a particular place

****帶某人到.....；引導某人前往.....****

Examples

1. He **led me upstairs**.
他**帶我上樓**。
2. The path **leads visitors to the lake**.
這條小徑會**引導遊客走向湖邊**。

4. lead the way

= go first and show others the route
帶路；走在前面

Examples

1. I don't know the route, so you **lead the way**.
我不知道路，所以你來**帶路**吧。
2. She **led the way** through the narrow passage.
她走在前面，**帶大家穿過狹窄通道**。

Direction / destination

5. road/path/door leads to somewhere

= provide a route to a place
通往；通向

Examples

1. This road **leads to the village**.
這條路**通往那個村莊**。
2. The stairs **lead to the second floor**.
這座樓梯**通往二樓**。

Here, no person is actively guiding anyone.

6. lead into / out of / through

= connect or provide a route into, out of, or through a place

****通向；連接到****

Examples

1. The hallway ****leads into the kitchen****.

走廊****通向廚房****。

2. A narrow gate ****leads out to the garden****.

一道窄門****通往花園****。

Leadership

7. lead a group / team / organization

= be in charge of and direct a group

****領導；帶領****

Examples

1. She ****leads a team of twenty people****.

她****帶領一個二十人的團隊****。

2. He was chosen to ****lead the project****.

他被選中****領導這個專案****。

8. lead a country / company / department

= hold the main leadership responsibility

****領導；主管****

Examples

1. She now ****leads the company's design division****.

她現在****領導公司的設計部門****。

2. He has ****led the organization**** for five years.

他已經****領導這個組織****五年。

9. lead by example

= influence others through your own behavior rather than only giving instructions

****以身作則****

Examples

1. Good managers ****lead by example****.
優秀的管理者會****以身作則****。
2. She encourages honesty by ****leading by example****.
她透過****以身作則****來鼓勵大家誠實。

Cause / result

10. lead to something

= cause or result in something

****導致；造成****

This is one of the most important abstract uses.

Examples

1. Poor communication can ****lead to misunderstandings****.
溝通不良可能****導致誤會****。
2. Lack of sleep may ****lead to poor concentration****.
睡眠不足可能****導致注意力下降****。

11. lead someone to do something

= cause, influence, or persuade someone to do something

****使某人做.....；促使某人.....****

Examples

1. Her encouragement ****led me to apply**** for the programme.
她的鼓勵****促使我申請****那個計畫。
2. The evidence ****led investigators to question**** the original explanation.
證據****促使調查人員質疑****原本的解釋。

12. lead someone to believe / think / conclude

= cause someone to form a particular belief or conclusion

****使某人相信 / 認為 / 得出結論****

Examples

1. His tone ****led me to believe**** that something was wrong.
他的語氣****讓我相信****事情有些不對。
2. The results ****led researchers to conclude**** that the method was effective.
結果****使研究人員得出結論****，認為這個方法有效。

Very high-value academic pattern.

Influence / development

13. lead someone in a particular direction

= influence someone toward a particular course of action or development

****引導某人朝某個方向發展****

Examples

1. Her advice ****led me in a better direction****.
她的建議****引導我朝更好的方向前進****。
2. Good feedback can ****lead students toward greater confidence****.
良好的回饋可以****引導學生建立更多自信****。

Being first / ahead

14. lead a race / competition

= be in first position

****領先；居首****

Examples

1. She **led the race** from the beginning.

她從一開始就**領先比賽**。

2. Our team **led by two points** at half-time.

中場休息時，我們隊**領先兩分**。

15. lead by + amount

= be ahead by a particular number or amount

領先.....

Examples

1. The team **leads by ten points**.

球隊**領先十分**。

2. She **led by three seconds**.

她**領先三秒**。

16. lead the field

= be the best, most advanced, or most successful in a group

領先同業；居領先地位

Examples

1. The company **leads the field in battery technology**.

這家公司在電池技術方面**居業界領先地位**。

2. She **leads the field** in this area of research.

她在這個研究領域**處於領先地位**。

Life / lifestyle

17. lead a life

= live a particular kind of life

過.....的生活

Examples

1. He **leads a quiet life** in the countryside.
他在鄉下**過著平靜的生活**。

2. She **led a very active life**.
她曾**過著非常活躍的生活**。

This is a distinct established construction.

18. lead a normal / busy / healthy life

= live in a particular way

過著正常 / 忙碌 / 健康的生活

Examples

1. After treatment, he was able to **lead a normal life**.
治療後，他能夠**過正常生活**。

2. She **leads a healthy lifestyle**.
她**過著健康的生活方式**。

Discussion / activity

19. lead a discussion / meeting

= direct or guide a discussion or meeting

主持；帶領

Examples

1. She **led the discussion** confidently.
她很有自信地**主持討論**。

2. He will **lead the meeting** tomorrow.
他明天會**主持會議**。

20. lead an investigation / campaign / initiative

= be chiefly responsible for directing an organized activity

****主導；領導****

Examples

1. She ****led the investigation****.
她****主導了調查****。
2. The team ****led a campaign**** to improve safety.
團隊****發起並主導一項活動****以改善安全。

Noun meanings — /li:d/

21. the lead — first position

= the position of being ahead of others

****領先地位****

Examples

1. Our team took ****the lead**** in the second half.
我們隊在下半場取得了****領先****。
2. She is currently in ****the lead****.
她目前處於****領先位置****。

22. take the lead

A. move into first position

****取得領先****

1. The runner ****took the lead**** near the finish.
那名跑者在接近終點時****取得領先****。

B. assume leadership or initiative

****帶頭；率先行動****

2. Someone needs to ****take the lead**** on this project.
必須有人在這個專案上****帶頭負責****。

Very important dual use.

23. have / hold the lead

= remain in first position

****保持領先****

Examples

1. The team ****held the lead**** until the end.
球隊一路****保持領先****到最後。
2. She has a narrow ****lead**** over her nearest competitor.
她只比最接近的競爭者****小幅領先****。

24. a lead — information that may help solve something

= a piece of information that may help an investigation or search progress

****線索****

Examples

1. Police are following several ****leads****.
警方正在追查幾條****線索****。
2. The phone record gave investigators a new ****lead****.
電話紀錄給調查人員提供了一條新的****線索****。

A genuinely distinct noun meaning.

25. follow up a lead

= investigate a useful clue further

****追查線索****

Examples

1. Detectives are ****following up a lead****.
偵探正在****追查一條線索****。
2. The journalist ****followed up the lead**** and found new evidence.

記者**順著線索追查**，找到了新證據。

Sales/business

26. a lead — potential customer

= a person or organization that may become a customer

潛在客戶；銷售線索

Examples

1. The campaign generated hundreds of new **leads**.

這次行銷活動帶來數百個新的**潛在客戶名單**。

2. The sales team contacted promising **leads**.

銷售團隊聯絡了幾個有潛力的**銷售線索 / 潛在客戶**。

Very common in sales and marketing.

27. sales lead

= information about a potential buyer

銷售線索；潛在客戶資訊

Examples

1. The website generates **sales leads**.

這個網站會產生**銷售線索**。

2. Each **sales lead** is assigned to a representative.

每個**潛在客戶線索**都會分派給一名業務代表。

Acting / performance

28. the lead — main role in a film, play, etc.

= the most important acting role

主角；主角角色

Examples

1. She plays **the lead** in the new film.

她在新電影中飾演**主角**。

2. He was offered **the lead role**.

他獲邀出演**主角**。

29. lead actor / lead actress

= principal performer in a production

男 / 女主角；主要演員

Examples

1. She won an award for best **lead actress**.

她獲得最佳**女主角**獎。

2. The **lead actor** gave an excellent performance.

那名**男主角**表現非常出色。

Journalism / information

30. lead — main or opening part of a news story

= the opening section of a news story containing the most important information

導語；新聞開頭

Examples

1. The journalist rewrote the **lead**.

記者重寫了新聞的**導語**。

2. A strong **lead** should capture the reader's attention.

好的新聞**導語**應該能吸引讀者。

In journalism, this is often also spelled **lede** to avoid confusion.

Electrical / connecting wire

31. lead — connecting wire / cable

= a wire or cable used to connect electrical equipment

****導線；連接線****

Examples

1. Connect the red ****lead**** to the positive terminal.

把紅色****導線****接到正極。

2. The power ****lead**** is damaged.

電源****線****損壞了。

Pronunciation: ****/li:d/****.

Animal control

32. lead — leash for an animal

Especially British English:

= a strap or cord used to control a dog or other animal

****牽繩；狗繩****

Examples

1. Keep your dog on a ****lead****.

請給你的狗繫上****牽繩****。

2. She attached the ****lead**** to the dog's collar.

她把****狗繩****扣在狗的項圈上。

American English more commonly uses ****leash****.

PART B — LEAD /led/

33. lead — the metal

= a heavy, soft, grey chemical element

****鉛****

Pronunciation: ****/led/****

Examples

1. The pipes contained **lead**.

那些管線含有**鉛**。

2. Exposure to **lead** can be harmful.

接觸**鉛**可能有害。

This is completely different in pronunciation and meaning from **lead** /li:d/.

34. lead poisoning

= illness caused by excessive exposure to lead

鉛中毒

Examples

1. Old paint can create a risk of **lead poisoning**.

舊油漆可能造成**鉛中毒**風險。

2. Children are especially vulnerable to **lead poisoning**.

兒童尤其容易受到**鉛中毒**影響。

35. lead-free

= containing no lead or a very low amount of lead

無鉛的

Examples

1. The product uses **lead-free solder**.

這項產品使用**無鉛焊料**。

2. The company switched to **lead-free materials**.

公司改用**無鉛材料**。

Important morphology

36. lead – led – led

For the verb **lead** /li:d/:

* present: **lead**

* past: **led**

* past participle: **led**

Examples

1. She **leads** the team now.

她現在**領導**這個團隊。

2. She **led** the team last year.

她去年**領導**這個團隊。

3. She has **led** several projects.

她已經**領導過**好幾個專案。

Important spelling warning

led is the past tense of **lead**.

Not:

lead ❌ as the normal past-tense spelling.

Related forms

37. leader

= a person who leads a group, organization, country, etc.

領導者；**領袖**

Examples

1. She is a strong **leader**.

她是一位很有能力的**領導者**。

2. Good **leaders** listen carefully.

好的**領導者**會仔細傾聽。

38. leadership

= the activity, ability, or position of leading

****領導；領導能力；領導地位****

Examples

1. She showed excellent ****leadership****.
她展現出優秀的****領導能力****。
2. The course focuses on ****leadership skills****.
這門課著重於****領導技巧****。

39. leading — adjective: most important / successful

= among the most important, famous, or successful
****領先的；主要的；頂尖的****

Examples

1. She is a ****leading expert**** in the field.
她是該領域的****頂尖專家****。
2. The company is a ****leading manufacturer**** of medical equipment.
這家公司是醫療設備的****主要製造商之一****。

40. leading — adjective: main / principal

= most important or prominent
****主要的；首要的****

Examples

1. Cost was the ****leading concern****.
成本是****主要考量****。
2. He played a ****leading role**** in the project.
他在專案中扮演了****主要角色****。

41. misleading

= causing someone to believe something incorrect
****誤導的；容易使人產生錯誤理解的****

Examples

1. The advertisement was ****misleading****.
這則廣告具有****誤導性****。
2. The graph gives a ****misleading impression****.
這張圖表給人一個****錯誤印象****。

This is a highly useful family extension.

42. mislead

= cause someone to believe something false or incorrect
****誤導；使產生錯誤理解****

Examples

1. The headline may ****mislead readers****.
標題可能會****誤導讀者****。
2. I did not mean to ****mislead you****.
我不是故意要****誤導你****。

Forms:

- * mislead
- * misled
- * misled

Key contrasts

43. lead vs guide

****lead****

= go first, direct, control, or influence

****帶領；領導****

****guide****

= show someone the way or give advice/instructions

****引導；指導****

Compare:

> She **led** the team.

> 她領導團隊。

> She **guided** the students through the exercise.

> 她引導學生完成練習。

Lead often implies greater responsibility or authority.

44. lead vs manage

lead

= set direction, motivate, influence

manage

= organize, administer, and control day-to-day work

A person can:

* manage efficiently

* lead poorly

or vice versa.

45. lead to vs cause

Both can express causation.

lead to

= produce or contribute to a result

導致

cause

= directly bring something about

造成

Compare:

> Stress can **lead to** poor sleep.

> 壓力可能導致睡眠不佳。

> The collision **caused** serious damage.

> 碰撞造成嚴重損壞。

Lead to often sounds less absolute and more process-oriented.

46. lead to vs result in

These are very close.

* **lead to** = 導致

* **result in** = 導致 ; 造成

result in is often slightly more formal.

47. lead vs head

When talking about leadership:

lead a team

= actively direct the team

head a team/department

= be its official head

Compare:

> She **heads** the department.

> 她是部門主管。

> She **leads** the department through major changes.

> 她帶領部門經歷重大變革。

48. lead vs take charge

lead

= direct over a period of time

take charge

= assume control or responsibility, especially at a particular moment

****接管；負責****

High-value expressions

49. lead the way

= be first to act or develop something

****帶頭；率先****

Examples

1. The company is ****leading the way in renewable energy****.

這家公司在再生能源方面****走在前列****。

2. Young researchers are ****leading the way**** in this field.

年輕研究人員在這個領域****率先推動發展****。

This can be literal or figurative.

50. lead someone astray

= cause someone to behave badly, make poor choices, or believe something wrong

****把某人引入歧途；誤導某人****

Examples

1. He worried that bad influences might ****lead his son astray****.

他擔心不良影響會把兒子****帶入歧途****。

2. Faulty data can ****lead researchers astray****.

錯誤資料可能會****誤導研究人員****。

51. lead up to something

= happen before and prepare for an important event

****導向；為.....鋪墊****

Examples

1. Several events **led up to the decision**.

好幾件事最終**導向了這項決定**。

2. The documentary examines the months **leading up to the election**.

這部紀錄片探討選舉前幾個月**逐步發展的事件**。

Useful phrasal construction.

52. lead off

= begin an activity, discussion, performance, etc.

首先開始；帶頭開始

Examples

1. She **led off the discussion** with a question.

她用一個問題**率先展開討論**。

2. The first speaker **led off** with a short introduction.

第一位講者以簡短介紹**開場**。

Meaning map

The core idea of **lead /li:d/** is:

be in front and cause others or events to move in a particular direction

From this develop:

Physical guidance

lead someone to a room

→ **帶領**

Route

road leads to the station

→ **通往**

Leadership

lead a team

→ **領導**

Causation

lead to problems

→ **導致**

Influence

lead someone to believe

→ **使某人相信**

First position

lead the race

→ **領先**

Lifestyle

lead a quiet life

→ **過著.....生活**

Noun: first position

take the lead

→ **取得領先 / 帶頭**

Noun: useful information

a lead in an investigation

→ **線索**

Noun: potential customer

sales lead

→ **潛在客戶線索**

A completely separate homograph is:

lead /led/

→ heavy metal

→ **鉛**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
lead someone somewhere	帶領某人前往某處；在前面引導方向
lead the way	走在前面帶路；比喻率先行動或走在領先位置
road/path leads to...	某條道路、路徑或入口通往某地
lead a team/organization	負責指揮、帶領或領導一群人 / 組織
lead by example	透過自己的行動示範應有的行為；以身作則
lead to + result	某件事造成、促成或導致後面的結果
lead someone to do	促使、影響或使某人採取某項行動
lead someone to believe/think	使某人形成某種看法、信念或判斷
lead a race / lead by X	在比賽、排名或數值比較中處於領先位置
lead the field	在某個領域中處於最先進或最優秀的位置
lead a life	過某種特定方式的生活
lead a meeting/discussion	主持、引導會議或討論
the lead — first position	領先位置；處於其他人前面
take the lead — competition	取得領先位置
take the lead — initiative	主動帶頭、承擔主要領導責任
a lead — clue	可以幫助調查、搜尋或解決問題的線索
a lead — potential customer	可能成為顧客的人 / 組織；銷售線索
the lead — acting	電影、戲劇等作品中的主要角色；主角
lead — journalism	新聞報導中概括最重要資訊的開頭 / 導語
lead — electrical wire	連接電氣設備的導線 / 連接線
lead — animal leash (BrE)	用來牽狗等動物的牽繩
lead /led/ — metal	鉛；一種沉重柔軟的灰色金屬
leader	領導者；帶領群體或組織的人
leadership	領導行為、領導能力或領導地位
leading — prominent	在某領域中主要、重要、頂尖或領先的
mislead	使人產生錯誤理解或錯誤信念；誤導
misleading	容易令人形成錯誤理解的；具有誤導性的

Pronunciation-ready distinction

lead /li:d/

* **lead a team**
* **lead to**
* **take the lead**
* **a sales lead**

lead /led/

* **lead metal**
* **lead poisoning**
* **lead-free**

And remember:

lead /li:d/ → **led** /led/ → **led** /led/

> She **leads** the team now.

> She **led** the team last year.

Passage relevance

lead does not occur as a target word in the quoted sentence itself, but it connects naturally with the passage's later idea of:

> "work in a **leadership** role"

The practical family link is:

lead → **leader** → **leadership**

So in that context:

leadership = the ability or responsibility to guide, influence, and direct other people

領導能力 ; 領導職責

Core MCQ distinction to remember

lead /li:d/ can mean:

* **帶領**

* **領導**

* **通往**

* **導致**

* **促使**

* **領先**

* **過某種生活**

* noun: **領先地位 / 線索 / 潛在客戶 / 主角**

lead /led/ means:

* **鉛**

That pronunciation-and-meaning split is one of the most testable features of this word family.